

End-of-Day Handoff — 2026-03-11

Purpose

This document captures the current state of the collaborator UX work, collections/share product decisions, 3DE observations, server-launch clarification, and the exact next steps so work can resume cleanly even if the chat thread loses context.

Current status

Completed checkpoint commits

- 944cac8 — checkpoint: collaborator ux and media repair groundwork
- 6f4a453 — add review-server runbook and workspace review doc

Main areas completed in the codebase

- collaborator browse/tree restrictions
- collaborator modal simplification toward question-first workflow
- collections provenance corrections (CB: collections are AI-derived representative sets, not human-curated)
- 3DE collaborator control suppression (Looks, Thumbs hidden for collaborators)
- 3DE live-burst / settle behavior and busy-state improvements
- review-vs-3DE workflow separation
- explicit backlog and checkpoint documentation

Critical clarification about DevLauncher

A wrong assumption was corrected today.

What DevLauncher actually uses

DevLauncher is the separate menu bar app in:

- /Users/minime/Projects/Agent Manager

It does **not** use Inspirations' `.claude/launch.json`.

It reads project definitions from:

- /Users/minime/Projects/Agent Manager/config/projects.json

Relevant code:

- /Users/minime/Projects/Agent Manager/src/devlauncher/config.py
- /Users/minime/Projects/Agent Manager/src/devlauncher/process_manager.py
- /Users/minime/Projects/Agent Manager/src/devlauncher/app.py

How DevLauncher works

1. Reads `config/projects.json`.
2. Lists projects in the menu bar.
3. Uses TCP port checks every 5 seconds for green/red state.
4. Starts processes with `subprocess.Popen(..., shell=True, cwd=<project.path>, preexec_fn=os.setsid)`.
5. Stops only processes DevLauncher started itself.
6. Logs to `/tmp/devlauncher/<project-name>.log`.

What the Inspirations review launcher really is

The review/start path is the existing **Inspirations** entry in DevLauncher, defined in:

- `/Users/minime/Projects/Agent Manager/config/projects.json`

That entry already runs without `--reload`.

This is the correct launch path for review.

Why this mattered

Earlier reasoning treated `.claude/launch.json` as if DevLauncher consumed it. That was incorrect. The permanent fix for review startup is to rely on DevLauncher's real **Inspirations** project entry and evaluate stability using that path.

Important operational gap still open

Server stability / pre-share hardening

The Inspirations server on port 8001 is not yet considered operationally stable enough for collaborator sharing.

Observed behavior:

- one-shot local curl checks can succeed briefly
- the process can still disappear later
- browser-visible / DevLauncher-visible uptime is not yet reliable enough

Correct standard for saying “server is up”

The server is only considered up if all of these are true:

1. DevLauncher shows **Inspirations** running.
2. Browser loads `http://127.0.0.1:8001/`.
3. `http://127.0.0.1:8001/api/me` returns 200.

A one-shot shell `curl` is not sufficient evidence by itself.

Supporting files

- /Users/minime/Projects/Inspirations/docs/REVIEW_SERVER_RUNBOOK_2026-03-11.md
- /Users/minime/Projects/Inspirations/tools/check_review_server.sh

Collaborator UX state

Implemented

- collaborators default into shared collections scope
- collections tree expanded by default for collaborators
- collaborators do not see:
 - Other / Non-Home-Design
 - Irrelevant / Discarded
- collaborator asset/source browsing excludes effective tracks:
 - irrelevant
 - home_maintenance_diy
- + New Collection is owner-only
- collaborator-only browse unlock affordances removed
- collaborator modal is question-oriented
- collaborator cannot write shared general notes
- collaborator modal prompt above image encourages question placement
- collaborator annotations are question-only
- 3DE Looks hidden for collaborators
- 3DE Thumbs hidden for collaborators

Still open on collaborator view

- collection-scoped share UI
- collaborator modal header/share redesign
- modal next/prev
- question flow polish:
 - Enter submit/close
 - Shift+Enter newline
 - confirm delete
 - numbering
- pre-share hardening / stable review startup

Neutral mode rule

A product rule was established:

- unauthenticated neutral mode must never expose more than collaborator mode
- neutral visibility must be less than or equal to collaborator visibility
- especially for:
 - hidden
 - irrelevant

- maintenance
- non-home content

Collections product model

A clearer model was established today.

Collection intents

Every collection should have explicit intent:

- **shared**
- **working**

Shared collections

Shared collections are for human collaboration.

Rules:

- every shared collection must name a collaborator
- questions are always enabled for shared collections
- collaborators should not see working collections

Primary use:

- Leslie (most likely) or Jim makes a named collection for a collaborator
- the collaborator receives a magic link
- the collaborator can review that collection and ask questions in context

Examples of audiences:

- interior designer
- cabinet maker
- tile person
- other specific role/person involved in the home project

A separate formal role field may be optional later, but a named person is the minimum requirement.

Working collections

Working collections are internal workflow objects.

Primary use:

- debugging
- curation review
- understanding the corpus
- improved categorization
- internal construction concern review

Construction collections rule

For now, construction-track collections should be treated as **working** collections, not style-side shared artifacts.

Construction UX/product direction

A separate model emerged for construction.

Primary construction users

1. Jim + Leslie
 - understand the concern corpus
 - map concerns into:
 - checklist items
 - contract/spec requirements
 - product selections
 - vetting questions
 - inspection points
2. Construction administrator
 - help ensure work is done to spec
 - help determine what must be communicated to subcontractors
 - support vetting and inspection communication

Key conclusion

Construction is not primarily a style-style collaborator collection problem.

It is primarily a:

- concern understanding
- concern organization
- migration-to-checklist/spec
- execution-readiness

workflow.

Therefore:

- do not force construction into the same style-side shared-collection UX
- construction needs its own dedicated UX/workflow sprint

3DE conclusions

What was observed

- turning on all **Subject Type** attractors at once distorted the map but was hard to interpret
- turning them off made migration toward remaining poles easier to see

Interpretation

This appears to be two things at once:

1. expected attractor behavior when all poles of one axis are active at the same time
2. a real sign that the current **Subject Type** enumeration may not be semantically strong enough for exploratory use

Refined issue statement

The real issue is not just “3DE felt odd.”

It is:

- refine the **Subject Type** enumeration itself
- clarify the meaning of each value
- evaluate whether the current values are genuinely useful for exploration and understanding

This is now explicitly tracked in the UX backlog.

Collections/share workflow sprint direction

A dedicated collections/share sprint is needed.

That sprint should cover:

- collaborator entry behavior
- collection tree defaults
- collection-scoped sharing
- share-link UX
- the distinction between shared vs working collections
- the neutral-vs-collaborator visibility rule

Important nuance:

- backend/URL support for collection-scoped links already exists via `collection_id`
- what is missing is the productized UX around it

Untracked workspace review

A doc was created for unrelated untracked files that were left out of the check-point:

- `/Users/minime/Projects/Inspirations/docs/UNTRACKED_WORKSPACE_REVIEW_2026-03-11.md`

You explicitly said review of that doc is delayed for now.

Stray file note

This untracked media file exists at repo root:

- `/Users/minime/Projects/Inspirations/The Hidden Cost of Union Power Rich Contracts and Layoffs Down the Road [865574612774175].f1440144380661259a.m4`

It was discovered via `git status --short`.

Current recommended next-step order

1. Dedicated collections/share workflow sprint.
2. Pre-share hardening pass if DevLauncher-launched `Inspirations` still proves unstable.
3. Continue UX sprint:
 - collaborator modal/share redesign
 - modal next/prev
 - `Subject Type` refinement for 3DE/exploration
4. Construction-specific UX/workflow sprint.

Immediate restart point for next session

When work resumes:

1. start `Inspirations` from DevLauncher
2. verify server-up state by the full standard (DevLauncher + browser + `/api/me`)
3. begin the collections/share workflow sprint from the now-settled rules above